

CHAPTER 4

Modals, Questions, and Negatives

Modal verbs, sentence transformation, and question formation

Study • Practice • Review

Prepared as a structured learning handout

1. Learning Objectives

- Use modal auxiliary verbs to express ability, permission, obligation, possibility, and advice.
- Construct negative sentences across common sentence structures.
- Form Yes/No questions and WH-questions accurately.

2. Modal Auxiliary Verbs

Modal verbs are helping verbs that express ability, permission, possibility, necessity, advice, or related meanings. A modal is followed by the **base form (V1)** of the main verb.

Modal	Common use	Example
can	Present ability / casual permission	I can code in Python. / Can I use your pen?
could	Past ability / polite request	I could run fast. / Could you help me?
may	Formal permission / possibility	May I enter? / It may rain.
might	Possibility, often less certain	He might join us.
must	Strong obligation / rule / deduction	Students must wear uniforms.
should / ought to	Advice / recommendation	You should submit the report.
would	Polite offer / hypothetical condition	Would you like tea?

3. Rules for Sentence Transformation: Negatives

Place **not** immediately after the auxiliary verb or modal.

With be, have, or a modal: She is a designer → She **is not** a designer. You should go → You **should not** go.

Simple Present / Past: If there is no auxiliary, use do/does/did + not, and return the main verb to V1.

*He likes tea → He **does not like** tea.*
*She visited Nepal → She **did not visit** Nepal.*

4. Question Formation

A. Yes / No Questions

Move the auxiliary verb before the subject.

*She is reading. → **Is she reading?***
*They can drive. → **Can they drive?***
*You like coffee. → **Do you like coffee?***
*He passed the exam. → **Did he pass the exam?***

B. Open-Ended WH-Questions

A common pattern is **WH-word + auxiliary + subject + main verb + ...?**

WH-word	Information sought	Example
Who	Person	Who built this website?
What	Thing / action	What are you studying?

WH-word	Information sought	Example
Where	Place / location	Where is the library located?
When	Time / date	When does the exam start?
Why	Reason / cause	Why were you late?
How	Manner / method	How do I run this code?

5. Practice Exercises

A. Choose the modal:

- 1 You _____ submit your project before the deadline; otherwise, you will fail.
- 2 Excuse me, _____ I borrow your ruler for a moment?
- 3 He _____ speak three languages fluently when he was ten years old.
- 4 If you have a headache, you _____ rest for a while.
- 5 It is cloudy; it _____ rain in the afternoon.

B. Convert to negative:

- 1 Maya works at a tech firm in Kathmandu.
- 2 The students completed the lab experiment.
- 3 He can solve complex math problems easily.
- 4 We are meeting them at the cafeteria.

C. Form WH-questions:

- 1 She lost her key at the park.
- 2 The class starts at 8:00 AM.
- 3 They are studying because they have an exam tomorrow.

6. Chapter Test

- 1 Form a Yes/No question: "He has finished reading the entire book."
- 2 Make negative: "They brought their laptops to the lab."
- 3 Identify and correct the modal mistake: "She can to swim very fast."
- 4 Create a WH-question asking about location: "The new server is installed in the IT basement."
- 5 Which modal expresses strong legal or organizational obligation?

7. Answer Key

Practice A: 1. must 2. May / Could 3. could 4. should 5. may / might.

Practice B: 1. Maya does not work at a tech firm in Kathmandu. 2. The students did not complete the lab experiment. 3. He cannot solve complex math problems easily. 4. We are not meeting them at the cafeteria.

Practice C: 1. What did she lose at the park? 2. What time / When does the class start? 3. Why are they studying?

Test: 1. Has he finished reading the entire book? 2. They did not bring their laptops to the lab. 3. Remove "to": She can swim very fast. 4. Where is the new server installed? 5. Must.

Quick Rule: *Never use to between a modal and the main verb: can swim, should study, must leave, might rain.*